

STRATEGY GUIDE · 2026

Asgar.ai

AI Strategy & Growth

Generative Engine Optimization

G E O

How to Win AI Mentions & Be Referenced
in ChatGPT, Google AI Mode & Perplexity

800M+

ChatGPT
Weekly Users

750M+

Gemini
Monthly Users

16%+

AI Overviews
in Search

40–60%

Citation
Churn/Month

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01

What Is Generative Engine Optimization (GEO)?

Generative engine optimization (GEO) is the practice of positioning your brand and content so that AI platforms like Google AI Overviews, ChatGPT, and Perplexity cite, recommend, or mention you when users search for answers.

For bootstrapped form-builder Tally, ChatGPT became the #1 referral source. Across industries, the shift is already measurable — and accelerating.

800M+	750M+	16%+	40–60%
ChatGPT weekly users	Gemini monthly users	Searches with AI Overviews	Monthly citation turnover

“The question is no longer whether AI is changing discovery — it is whether your brand shows up when it happens.”

When researchers tracked 2,500 prompts across Google AI Mode and ChatGPT, 40–60% of cited sources changed month-to-month. Yet clear patterns emerged: consistently visible brands shared entity clarity, content extractability, and multi-platform presence.

GEO covers four core areas:

C Content Strategy Publishing information AI systems can discover, understand, and extract.	B Brand Presence Establishing authority across every platform — not just your website.
T Technical Optimisation Ensuring AI crawlers can access, render, and process your content reliably.	R Reputation Building Earning mentions and associations that signal credibility to AI systems.

02

GEO vs. Traditional SEO

GEO builds on the same SEO fundamentals you already use, but shifts the focus from rankings and clicks to how your brand is mentioned and cited inside AI-generated answers.

What Changes	Traditional SEO	GEO
Primary Goal	Rank in top positions	Be referenced in AI-generated answers
Success Metrics	Rankings, clicks, traffic	Citations, mentions, share of voice
How Users Find You	Click through to your site	AI includes you in generated responses
Key Platforms	Google, Bing	Google AI Mode, ChatGPT, Perplexity
Content Optimisation	Title tags, keywords, site speed	Self-contained paragraphs, clear facts, structured data
Credibility Signals	Backlinks, domain authority	Positive mentions across trusted platforms

What stays the same

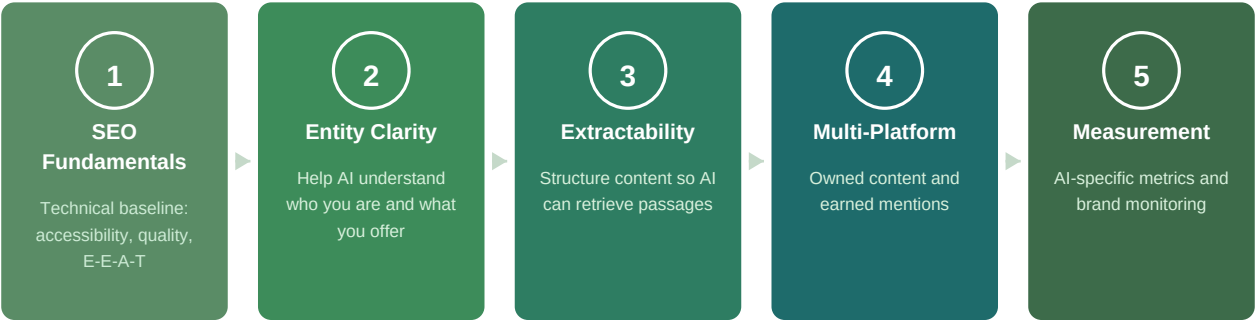
- ✓ High-quality, authoritative content
- ✓ Technical accessibility and crawlability
- ✓ Credible E-E-A-T signals
- ✓ Understanding user intent clearly

What changes in GEO

- Presence across Reddit, YouTube, review sites
- Self-contained, front-loaded paragraphs
- AI visibility metrics (SoV, citations, sentiment)
- Multi-platform brand consistency

The 5 Principles Framework

An effective GEO strategy rests on five connected principles. As AI systems evolve, specific tactics may shift — but these underlying principles provide a stable foundation.



SEO Fundamentals	The baseline that makes everything else possible. Accessible content that AI crawlers can reliably find and interpret.
Entity Clarity	Consistent brand signals across every platform so AI can confidently categorise and reference you.
Extractability	Self-contained paragraphs and front-loaded facts that AI can lift directly into generated answers.
Multi-Platform	A presence beyond your website — Reddit, YouTube, reviews, and industry publications all feed AI systems.
Measurement	New metrics like citation frequency, share of voice, and sentiment to track what traditional analytics miss.

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Principle 1 — SEO Fundamentals Are the Foundation

In AI-driven discovery, SEO fundamentals influence retrieval, interpretation, and attribution rather than rankings alone. AI-generated answers are assembled from content that is accessible, readable, and attributable — when any of these is weak, even strong content becomes harder to surface.

Technical Accessibility	Content that cannot be consistently crawled or rendered introduces uncertainty at the retrieval layer. JavaScript-heavy implementations challenge many AI crawlers.
Page Performance	Slower or unstable experiences reduce how dependable a source appears when AI assembles answers — they don't block inclusion outright, but reduce reliability.
E-E-A-T Signals	Experience, Expertise, Authoritativeness, and Trust influence not just whether content is referenced, but how it is framed. Information reflecting real experience and clear authorship is easier for AI to contextualise and trust.

KEY INSIGHT

These foundations explain why SEO still underpins GEO — not as a ranking system, but as the infrastructure that makes AI visibility possible.

05

Principle 2 — Entity Clarity Shapes AI Understanding

AI systems look for clear signals about what your brand is, what category it belongs to, what it offers, and what it is authoritative for. If those signals are unclear or inconsistent, AI has less confidence when deciding whether and how to reference you.

Practical examples

monday.com

The word ‘monday’ appears in countless contexts. Clear, consistent descriptions across the site and supporting sources help AI understand that monday.com is project management software — not the day of the week.

Organic dog food brand

If you sell organic dog food, AI needs to place you under pet nutrition, not general groceries. When someone asks for grain-free dog food, AI is more likely to mention brands it can clearly categorise.

How to build entity clarity

1

Align page structure, schema
& product feeds

2

Match LinkedIn bio with
website description

3

Sync Crunchbase, directories
& review profiles

4

Keep positioning consistent
across all channels

KEY PRINCIPLE

The goal isn't to ‘add schema.’ The goal is to make your information logically structured so machines can consistently understand it across all systems.

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Principle 3 — Content Must Be Easy to Extract and Reuse

Entity clarity determines whether AI considers your content. Extractability determines which specific parts get pulled into AI-generated answers.

LLMs break content into chunks, convert them into vectors, and retrieve the most relevant passages when assembling a response — often without the surrounding context from your original page.

What makes content extractable?

Self-contained paragraphs	Each paragraph expresses one complete idea without vague references to surrounding text.
Specific facts and statistics	Concrete numbers and clear statements are easier for AI to extract than vague generalisations.
Clear, descriptive headings	Headings signal what each section covers, helping AI understand content organisation.
Front-loaded information	The main point appears at the start of a paragraph — not buried at the end.

Hard to extract vs. Easy to extract

X Hard to Extract	✓ Easy to Extract
There are several reasons this method works. After trying it, most people find their eggplant tastes better. That's why many chefs use it.	Salting eggplant for 15 minutes before cooking removes bitterness and excess moisture, improving the final texture.
It's important for a few reasons we'll cover. Many businesses don't realise this until later.	Email marketing delivers an average ROI of 36:1 — for every \$1 spent, businesses earn \$36 in return.
We offer a unique approach that many clients have found helpful over the years.	Semrush provides keyword research, site audit, and competitor analysis tools in one platform.

IMPORTANT NOTE

This principle mainly applies to retrieval-augmented systems (Google AI Mode, Perplexity, ChatGPT with browsing). For base model knowledge, consistent authoritative publishing over time shapes how AI learns about your brand.

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Principle 4 — AI Visibility Extends Beyond Your Website

AI systems gather information from YouTube, Reddit, review sites, industry publications, social platforms, and more — creating two distinct visibility opportunities.

Owned Presence

- YouTube — product walkthroughs & demos
- Subreddit discussions in your niche
- Executive LinkedIn newsletters
- Podcasts, webinars, conference talks

Earned Mentions

- Customer reviews on G2, Capterra, Trustpilot
- Industry journalists citing your company
- Reddit & Quora organic recommendations
- Analyst reports referencing your data

Top cited source types by leading LLMs (Oct 2025)

Platform	Content Type	Why AI Cites It
Reddit	Community discussions	Authentic user sentiment and experience
LinkedIn	Professional articles	Expert perspectives and thought leadership
YouTube	Video transcripts	Demonstrations, tutorials, in-depth coverage
Review sites	Product reviews	Third-party trust signals and real sentiment
Industry pubs	Editorial features	Authoritative, well-sourced domain reporting

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Principle 5 — Measuring AI Visibility Differently

Traditional SEO had a clear attribution path: a user clicked, landed on your site, and either converted or did not. AI search breaks that path.

When an AI tool recommends your product, the user may never click through. The conversion may still happen — they search your brand name a week later — but your analytics won't trace it back to the AI mention that started it.

New metrics to track



Citation Frequency
How often AI platforms mention your brand when answering relevant questions



Share of Voice
Your mention rate vs. competitors across AI-generated responses



Context Tracking
Which prompts trigger your brand — reveals what topics you own



Sentiment
Positive, neutral, or negative?
Quality of mentions matters too

MEASUREMENT BLIND SPOT

Traditional analytics (GA4, Search Console) only see what happens after a click — creating a 'measurement blind spot' for AI-driven discovery.

You need a dedicated AI visibility dashboard tracking mentions, sentiment, and share-of-voice to see your full organic presence.

09

What This Framework Doesn't Guarantee

These principles increase your probability of appearing in AI answers. They do not guarantee it. Even well-optimised brands experience citation volatility.

📱 Different AI platforms weigh signals differently

👤 User context and history affect what gets cited

🔄 AI evolves rapidly — signals shift with each model update

🏆 No 'rank #1 in AI' equivalent to chase

“Think of GEO like brand building: you’re increasing your odds across many moments of potential visibility, not securing a fixed position. Showing up consistently, across surfaces, over time — that is how you build trust with AI systems.”

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Frequently Asked Questions

Is GEO replacing SEO?

No — GEO builds on SEO fundamentals. Traditional SEO optimises for rankings and clicks; GEO optimises for mentions, citations, and recommendations inside AI answers. Strong SEO creates the foundation that AI systems rely on when deciding which brands to reference.

What's the biggest misconception about GEO?

That AI-generated answers are too volatile to optimise for. While individual responses change, the underlying inputs do not. Brands with strong entity clarity and credible sources appear repeatedly, even as surface-level outputs fluctuate.

Does GEO favour large, well-known brands?

Established brands start with more authority, but they don't automatically win. Focused niche publishers can outperform larger brands when their expertise is clearer, better structured, and tightly aligned with specific audience needs.

What types of content most likely appear in AI responses?

Clear, direct answers to specific questions; self-contained explanations; fact-based comparisons; and concise definitions that make sense without surrounding context. AI pulls individual passages — structure and clarity matter more than length.

How should we think about GEO moving forward?

As a long-term visibility discipline, not a short-term tactic. Success requires alignment across content, SEO, brand, PR, and product — making your expertise clear, consistent, and reusable wherever AI systems look for answers.

Quick Reference — GEO at a Glance

Principle	Core Action	Why It Matters
SEO Fundamentals	Technical accessibility + E-E-A-T	Enables AI crawling, indexing, and trust
Entity Clarity	Consistent brand description everywhere	AI categorises and references you correctly
Extractability	Self-contained, front-loaded paragraphs	AI pulls exact passages into its answers
Multi-Platform	Owned content + earned mentions	More consistent signals = higher confidence
Measurement	Track citations, SoV, sentiment, context	Reveals your true AI search presence

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